

GTA Vice City PC pulled

Rockstar 'temporarily pulled' copies of GTA Vice City PC from digital distributors while it sorted out issues over music licensing



Vita Firmware 2.00 goes live

The Playstation Vita's 2.00 Firmware upgrade went live, with major changes including a faster We Browser and an Email Client Plus

NVIDIA introduced the GPU Boost which combines hardware and software to dynamically increase the GPU core clock speed based on the load on the GPU. Sounds very similar to Turbo Boost on Intel processors? Well, it kind of is.

Moving on from discrete graphics cards, we were also quite surprised with the integrated graphics performance on processors. Last year we were impressed with AMD Llano accelerated processing units (APUs) which gave playable frame rates with integrated graphics. This year, the update in terms of Trinity APUs was even better. If you want a graphics-card free system and still be able to play games, get these APUs.

Intel had also given us integrated graphics on Sandy Bridge processors, but for gaming, they were pathetic. This year with the Ivy Bridge processors and Intel HD 4000, the integrated graphics on Intel processors have significantly improved as compared to Intel HD 3000 seen on



AMD Trinity APUs gave fabulous integrated graphics performance

the Sandy Bridge flagship processors. However, the HD 4000 is still nowhere as compared to the HD 7660D found on the flagship Trinity APU.

All-in-all it was a great year for the graphics card industry and we were particularly impressed with the integrated graphics performance on processors. We wonder if card manufacturers will still bother with entry-level graphics cards next year?

Internet control (Bad)

Anonymous took some serious action in India when content censorship was rampant in mid-2012. When Reliance Communications blocked several websites to curb piracy, they were attacked by Anonymous India who hacked into their servers and made the list of blocked web-

sites public on May 26. Since then, they've hacked into some Indian government websites, defaced BJP and Trinamool Congress websites, and they had even called for a protest across various locations in India on June 9th.

Torrents are a grey area when it comes to sharing content. People can download movies, music and games without paying for it but that is the negative side. There are a whole bunch of legal torrents too. The government tried to block torrents, but users still managed to access them via proxy servers. In the end though, the ban was lifted.

In April, Chennai based Copyrights Labs got a John Doe order (an order against no one in particular) from Madras High Court which ordered ISPs to block several video hosting websites such as Vimeo and Dailymotion along with a string of torrent sites such as Isohunt and Pirate Bay. The motive was to prevent illegal sharing of the movies *3* and *Dhammu*. The ISPs went on this whole website blocking spree welcoming users with messages such as, "This website has been blocked as per instructions from the Department of Telecom (DoT)".

Although the ban on some blocked sites has been removed, the cloud of censorship continues to hover over the Indian cyber-territory. A cartoonist was arrested and charged with sedition for his cartoons, and later released. Two girls were recently arrested for their Facebook activity over the death of a political figure over charges as grave as 'hurting religious sentiments'. Indian government sent the second highest number of take-down notices to Google in the first half of the year. Long story short - the internet is no longer as free as we knew it.

The war for your living room never reaches you (Bad)

If there is one field of technology that is left behind when compared to the rest of the world, it is with regards to TV content distribution. Digital set top boxes haven't made their way into every living room that has a TV in India. This data partially changed when digitisation became compulsory in the metros, but has the distribution of content reached its fullest potential?

Xbox is more widely considered as a media hub rather than a gaming console. Unfortunately, it hasn't picked up the same reputation in India considering the appalling Internet speeds. Netflix, Hulu, Amazon have replaced the way the west watches their favourite shows and yet India is oblivious to these services. The



Airtel-Digital-tv

youth in India today downloads their favourite TV shows off the Internet, as the latest episodes aren't available on demand via any provider. And when we finally get the old seasons on our TV channels, they are heavily censored (even for language), thereby killing half the fun. Sure, the cable operators and DTH providers do give some channels in HD and offer a few movies on demand, but their services are negligible to the way content is consumed abroad. Google TV, Apple TV, Amazon and more are the one who are fighting to show off the library of content.

India is a potential market for these service providers especially if you see the plethora of soap operas that Indian viewers are addicted to. Localized content is plenty. If the average household could have access to decent Internet speeds and a service provider such as a Hulu or a Netflix would step in, content consumption would change in India considerably.

This is one revolution that needs to start in India and one that we are eagerly awaiting. We have seen some smart TV's and some Internet enabled TV boast of video content but it isn't enough to stir the market. Services such as Big Flix are giving users the ability to stream movies, but then again the constraint of bandwidth is the ultimate kryptonite... **[4]**